MARKETING MANAGER
ONBOARDING & OPERATING RUNBOOK

Learn the system. Inspect the evidence.
Lead the daily workflow.

Detailed training companion · Practical playbooks · Worked examples · Reusable templates

HOW TO USE THIS PACK

THE MANUAL

Detailed DOCX/PDF: procedures, manager checks, tools, review rubrics, scenarios, templates and answer keys.

THE TRAINING DECK

Walk the sequence with the assessor. Every gate must be demonstrated against real records privately; training is not authority by itself.

YOUR MANDATE AND YOUR LIMITS

MM RESPONSIBILITY	Strategy leadership, final internal approval and direct video-quality review.
WORK WITH AM	AM distributes, monitors and collects work; maintain one execution picture.
WORK WITH HEADS	Content/Design heads review their teams before MM final internal approval.
DO NOT ASSUME	Financial/platform authority, backup reviewers, SLAs and unconfirmed reporting lines.
NO FALSE READINESS	Owner/assessor confirms competence and delegated authority explicitly.

THE FIRST 30 DAYS / RECOMMENDED, NOT COMPANY SLA

DAYS 1–2	Read map; verify authorized access; trace one actual account with AM.
DAYS 3–5	Shadow quality reviews, revision loops and AM client-pack assembly.
WEEK 2	Run supervised daily checks and sample review decisions.
WEEK 3	Coordinate a small approved scope and report evidence-led actions.
WEEK 4	Demonstrate end-to-end reasoning and exceptions; record gaps and delegation.

MILESTONES YOU MUST KEEP SEPARATE

READY TO SIGN	After meeting one: only now start AM-led actual strategy with SM/MM/MB.
CONTRACT SIGNED	Move same folder out of Quotations; payment remains a separate gate.
FUNDS VERIFIED	Signed pack + required upfront payment enables contracted delivery.
INTERNALLY APPROVED	AM may gather finalized work into one client PPTX.
CLIENT APPROVED	SM receives approved version; final Design/Video archive allowed.

PEOPLE AND RELATIONSHIPS

14 POSITIONS	Keep Graphic Designers 1/2 and Video Editors 1/2 distinct.
REPORTING	Editors directly report to MM. Other lines remain proposed until confirmed.
COORDINATION	AM coordinates work; does not automatically line-manage production.
ACCOUNTABILITY	One holder per task; collaborators do not erase ownership.
APPROVAL	Quality, MM final internal and final client decisions are different.

WHERE TO FIND THE ANSWER

ACTUAL NEED	Meeting brief, actual strategy and signed scope—not only initial proposal.
CURRENT WORK	Task sheet, holder, inputs/dependencies, dates and current output.
REVIEW	Comment author, holder response, reviewer decision and version.
CLIENT RELEASE	AM presentation/version, final client decision and approved assets.
RESULTS / SPEND	Dated performance/listening sources and verified actual media expenses.

DRIVE AND SUBMISSION / THE IMPORTANT EXCEPTION

CONTENT WORKING CALENDAR

Submit on the sheet + upload monthly calendar PPTX to Drive. Comments stay on that same calendar.

DESIGN / VIDEO FINAL ARCHIVE

Store final copies only after internal and client approval. Draft-review location still needs confirmation.

DAILY LOOP / PROPOSED FOR CONFIRMATION

OPEN	AM/heads/MM check due work, missing inputs, owners and waiting decisions.
EXECUTE	Holders update tasks and references; AM coordinates blockers and scope.
REVIEW	Heads/MM give executable feedback tied to current output/version.
RELEASE	AM checks client approval; SM checks calendar, assets and community issues.
CLOSE	Reconcile sheet and daily-finished log; carry open comments and next owners forward.

SOP-01 / PROSPECT AND QUALIFY

WHEN IT STARTS

A potentially suitable business or an inbound lead is identified.

FULL STEPS IN RUNBOOK

1. Use on-ground visits, researched cold calls, LinkedIn search, email campaigns or calls to leads generated by PMP media buying.
2. Record the opportunity, contact, need, outreach outcome and next action in the agreed lead register. The lead-register tool and fields are proposed pending owner confirmation.
3. Book an online or offline first meeting. Keep the Account Manager involved.
4. Prepare a prospect/client-named folder inside PMP Drive / Quotations. Sales or BD is accountable for folder setup.

SOP-01 / WHAT THE MANAGER CHECKS

- Check why the business is a suitable prospect, which channel produced the lead and who owns the next action.
- Ask Sales/BD to distinguish a response, a booked meeting, interest, readiness to sign and a signed contract.
- Check that AM has context before the client meeting, rather than receiving the account after closing.

HOLD / RETURN: No clear service need or next owner: return for qualification; do not represent it as a won account.

SOP-02 / PREPARE THE AUDIT AND INITIAL PROPOSAL

WHEN IT STARTS

First meeting booked.

FULL STEPS IN RUNBOOK

1. Use supplied SKILL-1.md (SSM Strategy): confirm scope, format, language and available access.
2. Research before prescribing: brief, social channels, website, assets, competitors and category context. Record dated sources and what cannot be verified.
3. Label Observed facts, Interpretation and Recommendation separately. Public views alone do not prove paid boosting.
4. Prepare an initial strategy/proposal and three quotation tiers after the audit. Use actual market ranges, previous PMP prices, client industry/class and proposed scope.
5. Study the actual problems and proposed solutions carefully before meeting one.

SOP-02 / WHAT THE MANAGER CHECKS

- Open the actual source notes and proposal; a polished deck alone does not demonstrate research.
- Check that every claim is labeled as Observed, Interpretation or Recommendation. Inspect source dates and inaccessible-source disclosures.
- Compare proposed deliverables to the available assets and capacity. Do not approve a plan that assumes nonexistent footage or capabilities.
- Check the three tiers against proposed scope, actual market-range evidence and previous-price records. No invented market rates.
- Ensure Sales/BD has studied the problems and solutions rather than simply forwarding skill output.

HOLD / RETURN: Unsupported claim: relabel or verify. Missing pricing evidence: do not present an invented price as market-validated.

SOP-03 / FIRST MEETING AND READINESS TO SIGN

WHEN IT STARTS

Prepared first meeting takes place online or offline.

FULL STEPS IN RUNBOOK

1. Present observed problems, proposed solutions and scope options.
2. Capture the actual client brief: objectives, priorities, constraints, service needs and information that differs from the initial assumptions.
3. Establish whether the client is ready to sign the contract. Record that readiness separately from actual signature.
4. If not ready, keep the opportunity in pre-sales follow-up; actual-strategy development remains pending.

SOP-03 / WHAT THE MANAGER CHECKS

- Read the meeting brief and identify what changed from the initial assumptions.
- Look for an explicit client-readiness-to-sign record; interest or a successful meeting is not the same milestone.
- If readiness is absent, keep the actual-strategy working group pending. Sales/BD and AM retain the next pre-sales action.

HOLD / RETURN: Client not ready: remain in pre-sales. Do not start actual-strategy development simply because meeting one happened.

SOP-04 / DEVELOP THE ACTUAL STRATEGY

WHEN IT STARTS

Meeting one completed AND client confirms readiness to sign.

FULL STEPS IN RUNBOOK

1. AM compares the initial proposal with the actual brief and identifies mismatches, new requirements and assumptions needing correction.
2. AM develops the actual strategy with Social Media Specialist, Marketing Manager and Media Buyer.
3. Apply the supplied strategy method to the agreed scope; revisit evidence and disclose gaps rather than carrying unsupported proposal assumptions forward.
4. Reconcile strategy-driven scope changes with the agreed quotation before printing the second-meeting pack.

SOP-04 / WHAT THE MANAGER CHECKS

- Ask AM for a proposal-versus-actual-brief comparison before accepting the actual strategy.
- Work with AM, SM and MB to resolve mismatches in objective, channel, audience, resources, measurement and paid-media assumptions.
- Check whether changes affect deliverable quantities, production effort, scope or quotation; do not silently add work.
- Keep the proposal, actual strategy and agreed quotation distinguishable. The final strategy in the signing pack must reflect the actual brief.

HOLD / RETURN: Readiness not confirmed: stop this preparation step. Conflicting requirements: AM resolves them with client before promising delivery.

SOP-05 / SECOND MEETING, SIGNATURES AND FOLDER MOVE

WHEN IT STARTS

Client ready to sign; actual strategy and agreed scope/quotation prepared.

FULL STEPS IN RUNBOOK

1. Present all four printed materials at meeting two.
2. Client signs the client brief, actual strategy, agreed quotation and contract.
3. On contract signing, Sales or BD moves the SAME folder from PMP Drive / Quotations / [Client name] to PMP Drive / [Client name]. Do not duplicate it.
4. Retain quotation records and organize Start Strategy, Client Brief, Content/monthly calendars, Design/monthly final designs, Videos/monthly final videos and other scope-specific work.
5. AM opens the project WhatsApp group with client, PMP owner, Marketing Manager and relevant stakeholders.

SOP-05 / WHAT THE MANAGER CHECKS

- Check the printed brief, actual strategy, agreed quotation and contract refer to the same account and scope; all four must be signed.
- Confirm the folder was moved, not copied: before PMP Drive / Quotations / [Client]; after PMP Drive / [Client].
- Check quotation records are retained and production folders are organized for the correct client/month.
- Confirm AM established the client WhatsApp group and the appropriate stakeholders are included.

HOLD / RETURN: Folder moved but signatures/payment missing: do not infer delivery readiness from folder location.

SOP-06 / CONFIRM PAYMENT BEFORE CONTRACTED DELIVERY

WHEN IT STARTS

Commercial materials signed.

FULL STEPS IN RUNBOOK

1. For SOCIAL MEDIA MANAGEMENT ONLY: require 100% of the agreed contract amount before contracted work starts.
2. For a contract INCLUDING OTHER SERVICES: require at least 50% of the agreed contract amount before contracted work starts.
3. Record payment evidence and confirmation from the authorized verifier. A verbal claim or demo calculator is not verification of funds.
4. Treat the media-buying fee separately: after executing the plan, calculate the user-described 25% retainer on verified ACTUAL media expenses.

SOP-06 / WHAT THE MANAGER CHECKS

- Determine contract category from the agreed scope, not an assumption about the client.
- Social-management-only: require the full contract amount before delivery. Other-services-included: require at least half.
- Identify the authorized payment verifier with the owner; this manual does not assign that financial authority automatically to MM or AM.
- Separate the post-execution 25% media fee from the upfront contract gate and from the media budget.

HOLD / RETURN: Missing verification: hold contracted production. Do not invent balance dates, tax rules or media funding terms.

SOP-07 / BRIEF, ASSIGN AND MONITOR PRODUCTION

WHEN IT STARTS

Signed pack and required upfront payment confirmed.

FULL STEPS IN RUNBOOK

1. AM writes the actionable production brief and distributes tasks to Content, Design and Editing.
2. Give every task one accountable holder. Include account, priority, deadline, task brief, inputs, output/reference and required reviewer.
3. Record start/end dates as work progresses and keep task links, reviewer notes and task-holder notes current.
4. AM monitors execution, follows up on blockers and keeps the client context connected to the work.
5. Where a task has multiple contributors, identify one accountable owner; do not silently treat a shared sheet entry as ownership by everyone.

SOP-07 / WHAT THE MANAGER CHECKS

- Check every task has one accountable holder, its actual brief, a usable output definition, priority, deadline, input links and reviewer.
- Check upstream dependencies: the next person should not have to infer missing copy, dimensions, footage, terms or client instructions.
- Work through AM to maintain one execution view while heads manage their quality work.
- Review workload before promising a date; any numeric capacity limit or SLA must be agreed rather than assumed.

HOLD / RETURN: Missing inputs: block and assign follow-up. Multiple contributors without one accountable holder: clarify ownership before handoff.

SOP-08 / SUBMIT WORK AND EXECUTE COMMENTS

WHEN IT STARTS

Assigned output is ready for review or a reviewer requests changes.

FULL STEPS IN RUNBOOK

1. Content submits work on the sheet and uploads the working calendar PPTX to Content / relevant month; comments and revisions remain on that SAME calendar PPTX.
2. Design and Video submit work for review and update task-sheet references. The draft-review location is not specified; do not invent a mandatory Drive draft folder.
3. AM, Marketing Manager and relevant heads write actionable comments. Record author and context, not just a generic rejected status.
4. The task remains open until its accountable holder executes every comment and records the response.
5. Resubmit corrected work for review; do not assume a previous approval still covers revised material.

SOP-08 / WHAT THE MANAGER CHECKS

- For content, open the same monthly calendar PPTX used by the team; connect comments to the correct task/item.
- For Design/Video, inspect the task/reference and actual revision state; do not demand final Drive archival before final client approval.
- Make each comment executable: identify the item, problem, expected change and reason. Record the reviewer and owner response.
- Do not close a task because the holder says edits are done; verify through the required review decisions.

HOLD / RETURN: Conflicting comments: coordinate one resolved direction before asking the holder to execute both. Unresolved comment: task remains open.

SOP-09 / QUALITY AND FINAL INTERNAL APPROVAL

WHEN IT STARTS

Work submitted with comments addressed.

FULL STEPS IN RUNBOOK

1. Content work: Head of Content reviews quality, then Marketing Manager approves.
2. Design work: Head of Design reviews quality, then Marketing Manager approves.
3. Video work: Marketing Manager performs video-quality review and final internal approval. Editors report directly to Marketing Manager.
4. Record the quality-review result and Marketing approval as distinct decisions even when the same Marketing Manager performs both video checks.
5. If any reviewer rejects the task, return it to its holder with comments and repeat the required review after correction.

SOP-09 / WHAT THE MANAGER CHECKS

- Content: confirm Head of Content review first. Design: confirm Head of Design review first.
- Video: perform video-quality review yourself as MM and record it; then record the final internal approval as its own decision.
- Review the current output against brief, strategy, accuracy, brand requirements, completeness and the comment history.
- Do not treat head approval or MM approval as external client approval.

HOLD / RETURN: Quality fails: return to holder with comments. You are unavailable: use only a confirmed delegate; do not invent an override.

SOP-10 / COLLECT ONE PRESENTATION AND OBTAIN CLIENT APPROVAL

WHEN IT STARTS

All included work has passed quality review and Marketing approval.

FULL STEPS IN RUNBOOK

1. AM gathers the finalized deliverables into ONE client PPTX and checks that it matches the approved brief and scope.
2. AM presents that PPTX to the client and records the client's final approval for the presented version.
3. If the client rejects or requests changes, AM logs the comments, routes affected tasks back to their holders and monitors correction.
4. Repeat applicable internal reviews and collect the corrected presentation for renewed client approval.
5. After internal and client approval, archive final Design and Video copies in the correct monthly folders. Content calendars retain their working-review role.

SOP-10 / WHAT THE MANAGER CHECKS

- Inspect AM’s presentation manifest: every included deliverable must have its required internal reviews.
- Check the presented version is identifiable and the client approval refers to that version and included scope.
- If the client rejects one item, ensure AM routes that item to the correct holder and coordinates the required re-review and renewed client decision.
- After approval, confirm final Design/Video archive links correspond to approved copies. Content’s working calendar exception remains.

HOLD / RETURN: Client approval not evidenced: hold publication. Material changed after approval: prior approval does not automatically cover that change.

SOP-11 / SCHEDULE, PUBLISH AND MANAGE THE COMMUNITY

WHEN IT STARTS

AM hands over the client-approved presentation/calendar.

FULL STEPS IN RUNBOOK

1. Social Media Specialist gathers private-label calendars and consolidates scheduling requirements.
2. Schedule and publish the approved calendars; retain publication references.
3. Reply to comments on private-label pages. Maintain the account's agreed voice and route issues outside approved responses to AM/MM. Exact response-time targets are not yet confirmed.
4. Keep organic publication separate from paid activation. Paid work requires its agreed media plan, authorizations and funding; exact financial approval ownership must be confirmed.
5. If material changes after approval, return through the relevant review chain before publication.

SOP-11 / WHAT THE MANAGER CHECKS

- Check SM has the approved calendar/presentation and final assets for the correct account and platform.
- Review the publishing schedule, live/scheduled references and community exceptions; SM also handles private-label page replies.
- Keep paid activation separate from organic publication. Confirm the applicable agreed plan, authorizations and funding with MB.
- If someone asks for an urgent unapproved change, route it back through the relevant reviews; urgency is not an approval state.

HOLD / RETURN: Wrong account, asset, version or approval: do not proceed. Incident already live: use the agreed platform/account authority; document and escalate, not an invented blanket delete rule.

SOP-12 / REPORT, OPTIMISE AND INFORM SCALE

WHEN IT STARTS

Activity is live and performance/listening evidence becomes available.

FULL STEPS IN RUNBOOK

1. Social Media Specialist creates performance reports, listening reports and social strategy updates, in addition to calendar and community duties.
2. Media Buyer provides paid performance and verified actual media expenses; calculate the 25% post-execution fee from the agreed actual-expense basis.
3. AM gathers the client-facing reporting narrative; MM reviews strategic implications and next actions.
4. Feed findings into Diagnose, Design and Optimise. Scale only on supporting evidence and agreed scope; do not promise growth, ROAS or other results without evidence.
5. Record data gaps, recommendations and decisions. Weekly/monthly reporting appears in the supplied strategy framework; account-specific deadlines must be agreed.

SOP-12 / WHAT THE MANAGER CHECKS

- Ask SM for performance and listening reports, not only publication counts. Ask MB for paid performance and actual-spend evidence.
- Validate source dates, reporting period, metric definitions and missing-data labels before discussing results.
- Calculate the post-execution media fee from the agreed actual-expense basis; do not use planned or unused budget as actual spend.
- Translate findings into owned actions and a next-cycle recommendation; do not guarantee growth or fabricate baselines.

HOLD / RETURN: Data missing: mark unverified and assign the access/evidence action. Unagreed fee basis: resolve with authorized commercial/financial authority before final billing.

SOP-13 / COORDINATE SHOOTS, COLLECT MEDIA AND CONTROL EQUIPMENT

WHEN IT STARTS

A scoped shoot, photography assignment, podcast recording or related production is being arranged.

FULL STEPS IN RUNBOOK

1. AM arranges with the outsourced videography/photography team, podcast guests and PR person. Do not treat scheduling coordination as unrestricted contracting or financial authority.
2. SM plans and captures behind-the-scenes content within the agreed shoot scope.
3. SM collects photo/video data from the videographer/photographer and hands the relevant files/references to the assigned editors/designers.
4. SM takes full accountability for memory cards and studio tools; record custody and any issue so equipment responsibility does not disappear in the handoff.
5. Editors/designers acknowledge receipt through the agreed task/reference route. Verification and detailed issue/return logs are recommended controls to adopt.
6. If company hard drives are used, record the specific drive/location and named custodian. Several drives exist; their custody and backup policy still need confirmation.

SOP-13 / WHAT THE MANAGER CHECKS

- Ask AM for the outsourced crew, guest and PR arrangements, the task brief and expected outputs.
- Ask SM where the collected originals, recipient handoff and BTS output are referenced.
- Confirm SM can account for issued/returned memory cards and studio tools; a data handoff does not erase equipment accountability.
- If hard drives are used, identify the specific drive and named custodian. Do not assume a universal backup policy or SM custody of all drives.
- Enforce the documented role rule: Higgsfield account is only for the two video-editor positions.

HOLD / RETURN: Missing data, unreadable files or unaccounted equipment: record the issue, involve AM/SM and authorized leadership; do not format, overwrite or claim completion as a workaround. Backup/format controls must be explicitly adopted.

QUALITY / CONTENT AND DESIGN

CONTENT

Brief/strategy match; accurate facts and terms; brand voice; complete caption/script/CTA; comments executed; HC then MM.

DESIGN

Correct copy/offer; brand and legibility; agreed dimensions/exports; source inputs; HD then MM; no premature final archive.

QUALITY / VIDEO AND CLIENT PRESENTATION

VIDEO: DIRECT MM REVIEW

Check script, footage, timing, audio, subtitles, text/price accuracy and agreed export requirements. Record quality and internal approval separately.

CLIENT PACK: AM COORDINATION

Manifest matches internally approved work. Client approval covers the presented version; revised content goes back through relevant reviews.

REVISIONS / KEEP THE TASK OPEN

COMMENT	AM, MM or relevant head identifies item, issue, change and reason.
EXECUTE	Accountable holder implements every comment and records response.
RE-REVIEW	Required quality/MM layers decide current version.
CLIENT	Affected changed work returns to client through AM where approval is needed.
DO NOT EQUATE	Edits done or a green cell with final client approval.

EXCEPTIONS / YOUR DECISION QUESTIONS

PRE-SALES	Is readiness to sign actually confirmed? If not, actual strategy stays pending.
DELIVERY	Are signed pack, verified payment and required inputs present?
RELEASE	Is this exact version client-approved? If not, hold.
AUTHORITY	Is a delegate and scope confirmed? If not, ask owner rather than bypass.
EVIDENCE	Can the result/spend be verified? If not, label the gap and obtain sources.

REPORTING / MORE THAN POSTS AND VIEWS

SOCIAL MEDIA SPECIALIST

Calendars, strategies, performance reports, listening reports, scheduling/publication and private-label page replies.

MEDIA BUYER + AM/MM

Paid performance and actual expenses; AM/MM coordinate evidence-led recommendations. No invented baselines, spend or guaranteed outcomes.

COMMERCIAL ARITHMETIC / TRAINING ONLY

CONTRACT EXAMPLE

10,000 units: social-only needs 10,000; other-services-included needs at least 5,000. Signed pack and authorized verification still required.

MEDIA EXAMPLE

After execution, 8,000 verified actual-expense units × 25% = 2,000 fee. These are examples, not prices or market ranges.

WORKED CASE / ORBIT STUDIO IS FICTIONAL

MEETING ONE	Actual audience/assets differ from Sales/BD proposal; capture real brief.
NOT READY	Actual-strategy group stays pending until client readiness is confirmed.
READY → SIGN	AM/SM/MM/MB develop actual strategy; align scope; sign four materials.
PAY → PRODUCE	Verify required upfront amount; AM assigns; missing footage blocks reel.
REVIEW → RELEASE	Comments executed → quality/MM → AM pack → client approval → archive/publish.

TEMPLATES YOU CAN REUSE

CONTROL	Access/authority inventory; client snapshot; proposal-vs-brief comparison.
EXECUTION	Task/handoff card; comment and execution response; daily control note.
APPROVAL	Client pack manifest; quality/MM/client decision record.
EXCEPTIONS	Payment/spend evidence; incident/escalation note; performance/listening review.
ONBOARDING	Competency demonstration and explicit authority/constraints sign-off.

DEMONSTRATE BEFORE UNSUPERVISED OPERATION

TRACE	Locate actual brief, strategy, task, review chain and client approval privately.
DECIDE	Explain next permitted action and hold condition for each milestone.
REVIEW	Give executable feedback and keep unresolved comments visible.
REPORT	Separate observed evidence, interpretation and proposed action.
SIGN OFF	Assessor records competence, gaps and delegated authority—not just quiz completion.

OWNER DECISIONS STILL REQUIRED

PEOPLE AND OPERATING LIMITS

MM authority, payment verifier, platform/financial limits, backup reviewers, reporting lines, draft-review location, SLAs and escalation route.

COMMERCIAL AND TRAINING

Remaining balance terms, media funding/taxes/expense basis; assessor and competence sign-off. No policy is invented to fill the gaps.

COMPANY SOFTWARE / KNOW THE ACCESS BOUNDARY

HIGGSFIELD	VE-01/VE-02 ONLY. Forbidden for every other team member; MM is not an exception.
CLAUDE + CHATGPT	Company subscriptions. Verify assigned seat, administrator and approved data use.
CANVA + ADOBE	Company-provided programs. Confirm exact licences/applications and seat assignments.
NO PASSWORDS HERE	Keep credentials in the approved secure route, not this manual or task sheet.

SHOOTING / COORDINATION, MEDIA AND EQUIPMENT

AM	Arranges outsourced videography/photography, podcast guests and PR person.
SM	Collects source data, hands to assigned editors/designers and captures BTS.
SM CUSTODY	Full accountability for memory cards and studio tools; issue/return record is recommended.
HARD DRIVES	Several company drives exist. Name each custodian/location; backup policy is not yet confirmed.
RECEIVER CHECK	Recommended: confirm files open and are complete before clearing cards; adopt authorization and backup rules.

RUN THE SYSTEM THROUGH EVIDENCE, OWNERS AND DECISIONS

Know the next gate.
Keep one accountable holder.
Never lose the approval trail.

Use the full manual, practise with the assessor and confirm authority before live operation.